

The Gospel According to John

The Beginning

Genesis 1:1–2; Hebrews 11:1–3



¹In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

²He was with God in the beginning. ³Through Him all things were made, and without Him nothing was made that has been made. ⁴In Him was life, and that life was the light of men. ⁵The Light shines in the darkness, and the darkness has not overcome^a it.

The Witness of John

⁶There came a man who was sent from God. His name was John. ⁷He came as a witness to testify about the Light, so that through him everyone might believe. ⁸He himself was not the Light, but he came to testify about the Light.

⁹The true Light, who gives light to everyone, was coming into the world. ¹⁰He was in the world, and though the world was made through Him, the world did not recognize Him. ¹¹He came to His own, and His own did not receive Him. ¹²But to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God — ¹³children born not of blood, nor of the desire or will of man, but born of God.

The Word Became Flesh

Psalms 84:1–12

¹⁴The Word became flesh and made His dwelling among us.^b We have seen His glory, the glory of the one and only Son^c from the Father, full of grace and truth.

¹⁵John testified concerning Him. He cried out, saying, “This is He of whom I said, ‘He who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.’”

^a Or comprehended ^b Or and tabernacled among us ^c Or the Only Begotten or the Unique One

16 From His fullness we have all received grace upon grace. **17** For the law was given through Moses; grace and truth came through Jesus Christ. **18** No one has ever seen God, but the one and only Son, who is Himself God and^a is at the Father's side,^b has made Him known.

The Mission of John the Baptist

Isaiah 40:1–5; Matthew 3:1–12; Mark 1:1–8; Luke 3:1–20

19 And this was John's testimony when the Jews of Jerusalem sent priests and Levites to ask him, "Who are you?" **20** He did not refuse to confess, but openly declared, "I am not the Christ."

21 "Then who are you?" they inquired. "Are you Elijah?"

He said, "I am not."

"Are you the Prophet?"

He answered, "No."

22 So they said to him, "Who are you? We need an answer for those who sent us. What do you say about yourself?"

23 John replied in the words of Isaiah the prophet:

"I am a voice of one calling in the wilderness,

'Make straight the way for the Lord.'"^c

24 Then the Pharisees who had been sent **25** asked him, "Why then do you baptize, if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?"

26 "I baptize with^d water," John replied, "but among you stands One you do not know. **27** He is the One who comes after me, the straps of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie."

28 All this happened at Bethany beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing.

Jesus the Lamb of God

Matthew 3:13–17; Mark 1:9–11; Luke 3:21–22

29 The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, "Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world! **30** This is He of whom I said, 'A man who comes after me has surpassed me because He was before me.' **31** I myself did not know Him, but the reason I came baptizing with water was that He might be revealed to Israel."

32 Then John testified, "I saw the Spirit descending from heaven like a dove and resting on Him. **33** I myself did not know

^a Or *but the only begotten God, who* ; BYZ and TR *but the only begotten Son, who* ^b Greek *in the Father's bosom* ^c Isaiah 40:3 (see also LXX) ^d Or *in* ; also in verse 31 and twice in 33

courts, both sheep and cattle. He poured out the coins of the money changers and overturned their tables. ¹⁶To those selling doves He said, “Get these out of here! How dare you turn My Father’s house into a marketplace!”

¹⁷His disciples remembered that it is written: “Zeal for Your house will consume Me.”^a

¹⁸On account of this, the Jews demanded, “What sign can You show us to prove Your authority to do these things?”

¹⁹Jesus answered, “Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it up again.”

²⁰“This temple took forty-six years to build,” the Jews replied, “and You are going to raise it up in three days?”

²¹But Jesus was speaking about the temple of His body. ²²After He was raised from the dead, His disciples remembered that He had said this. Then they believed the Scripture and the word that Jesus had spoken.

²³While He was in Jerusalem at the Passover Feast, many people saw the signs He was doing and believed in His name. ²⁴But Jesus did not entrust Himself to them, for He knew them all. ²⁵He did not need any testimony about man, for He knew what was in a man.

Jesus and Nicodemus

Genesis 22:1-10; Romans 5:6-11



¹Now there was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a leader of the Jews.

²He came to Jesus at night and said, “Rabbi, we know that You are a teacher who has come from God. For no one could perform the signs You are doing if God were not with him.”

³Jesus replied, “Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again.”^b

⁴“How can a man be born when he is old?” Nicodemus asked. “Can he enter his mother’s womb a second time to be born?”

⁵Jesus answered, “Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can enter the kingdom of God unless he is born of water and the Spirit. ⁶Flesh is born of flesh, but spirit is born of the Spirit. ⁷Do not be amazed that I said, ‘You^c must be born again.’ ⁸The wind blows where it wishes. You hear its sound, but you do not know where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit.”

⁹“How can this be?” Nicodemus asked.

^a Psalm 69:9 ^b Or *born from above* ; also in verse 7. ^c The Greek word for *you* is plural; also in verse 12.